SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

English

EL 1000 - English Composition I: Exposition

Credits: 4

Designed to develop and refine students' ability to read, write and think critically. Selected essays will be read and studied as models of rhetorical style, enabling students to detect for themselves the effective use of language and to develop an appreciation for masterpieces of non fiction prose. Students will learn to develop the extended essay with particular attention to discovery and organization. Oral communication skills will be sharpened by directed discussion and by presentation and criticism of class papers. A grade of C or above is required to pass this course.

Prerequisites

EC I placement

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 1010 - Writing Workshop

Credits: 2

This two-credit course will provide students in English Composition with additional writing support. Students in this course will meet for an additional one hour and 30 minutes per week. During this time students will practice effective writing and reading strategies and engage in one-on-one tutoring sessions with their instructor. Students who earn a C or above in English Composition I will satisfy the English Composition I proficiency and be able to move on to English Composition II. Students who earn a C or above in English Composition II will satisfy the English Composition II proficiency

EL 1193 - ESOL III

Credits: 4

Designed to refine English language skills the multilanguage learner has already acquired. Basic grammatical forms are not directly taught but are reviewed in the context of specific writing activities. Emphasis is on the construction and revision of paragraphs and short compositions. Reading skills are strengthened through vocabulary expansion and exercises in comprehension, summarizing and outlining.

EL 1298 - ESOL IV English Composition for ESOL and Writing Workshop

Credits: 6

This 6 credit course is designed to improve students' critical thinking and academic writing skills as well as the ability to control such surface features as grammar, punctuation, diction, and spelling. We will read and discuss nonfiction prose that will serve as models for your own writing. You will learn that writing is a process, not a product, and will gain practice with planning, drafting, and revising essays. You will also learn to develop the extended essay with particular attention to discovery and organization. Oral communication skills will be sharpened by directed discussion and by presentation and criticism of student essays. ESOL IV is a six-credit course designed to provide students with additional writing support. Students in this course will meet for an additional one hour and 30 minutes per week. During this time students will practice effective writing strategies and engage in one-on-one tutoring sessions with their instructor. Students who earn a C or above in ESOL IV will satisfy the English Composition I proficiency and be able to move on to English Composition II.

EL 2001 - Public Speaking

Credits: 4

Designed to give the student the poise and confidence necessary to think and speak freely before an audience. This course proceeds from audience analysis through motivation, supporting materials, organization, and delivery.

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 2203 - Shakespeare: Three Plays

Credits: 4

This course examines Shakespearian themes which have intense relevance to today's divided society: sexism, racism, anti-Semitism, colonialism, and gender fluidity. Texts will include such plays as Othello, The Winter's Tale, The Merchant of Venice, Twelfth Night, The Tempest, as well as some of the sonnets. Students are required to write a reading journal, analytical essays, and a research paper. Most writing is done outside of class. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2205 - Psychological Themes in Literature

Credits: 4

This section will explore a variety of psychological themes such as development and aging, family dynamics, addictions, neurosis and psychosis in literary works by a selection of writers from different cultures. Themes will also be considered from the perspective of relevant psychological literature. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2206 - Science Fiction Literature

Credits: 4

Science fiction literature and film are often used to imagine utopian and dystopian worlds. At its best, the genre of science fiction raises questions about what makes a good society, the nature of being human, the role of the outsider, the challenges technological advances present, and gender and sexual norms. The course will examine fiction by authors such as George Orwell, Harlan Ellison, Samuel Delaney, Ursula LeGuin, Philip K. Dick, and Octavia Butler as well as films such as Blade Runner and The Matrix. Students will develop their ability to read and think critically and to write summaries, critical analyses and a research paper based on the course material. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2207 - Contemporary American Fiction

Credits: 4

Students will read and analyze short fiction by authors who reflect the diversity of contemporary American fiction, such as Raymond Carver, Alice Walker, Sandra Cisneros, Junot Díaz, Jhumpa Lahiri, Maxine Hong Kingston, Tim O'Brien, and others. Analysis of the short story will acquaint students with literary form and structure. Biographical and historical factors will be examined as influences on content and form. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2208 - Modern American Poetry

Credits: 4

This lecture/discussion course will focus on trends and themes in modern American poetry in the context of the search for an American poetic voice. Poets range from Whitman to Walker and include Frost, Harper, Hughes, Komunyakaa, Sarton, Sexton, Wilbur, Wright, and others. Formal analysis and biographical factors are studied. Students will also become involved in "found poetry" and practice poetic forms. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2211 - Africana Perspectives

Credits: 4

Explores recurring themes and modes of expression in the Pan-African world, ranging from the role of the oral tradition in traditional African societies to African-American rebellion as expressed in contemporary writing and music. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2214 - Literature and Liberation

Credits: 4

Examines fiction, poetry, essays, and drama about class-economic struggle, war, and racial and sexual oppression. Through these kinds of literature, oppressed people have voiced their ideas on ethics, politics, and society, and other social groups have responded positively or negatively. The course stresses close reading of literature, understanding

literary themes and techniques, reading in historical context, and training in quotation, citation, and research methods. Two or three short interpretations and a research paper are required.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2216 - Multicultural Perspectives

Credits: 4

Works from writers of various cultures enable students to develop an understanding and appreciation of cultural diversity. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Every year.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2218 - The Short Story

Credits: 4

A variety of short stories will be studied for theme and structure and other elements of fiction. Emphasis on the development of the short story in the context of literary movements, such as realism, naturalism, impressionism. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Every year.**Note:**

A grade of “C” or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2219 - International Short Stories

Credits: 4

Students will read a variety of short stories by authors from around the world, including Russia, Kenya, Brazil, India, and Japan. Emphasis on character and culture, as shaped by social factors. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Every year.**Note:**

A grade of “C” or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2221 - Adolescent Literature

Credits: 4

Traces the patterns and problems of growing up in America and forming an identity in the context of family influence and social pressures. Authors include Twain, Salinger, McCullers, Baldwin, Marshall, Potak, Walker. Interpre tive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Every year.**Note:**

A grade of “C” or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2222 - Women’s Voices

Credits: 4

This lecture/discussion course focuses on developing students' abilities to understand, analyze, and write about literature by women writers. Texts studied include essays, poems, stories, and novels by Emily Bronte, Emily Dickinson, Virginia Woolf, Flannery O'Connor, Gwendolyn Brooks, Toni Morrison, Alice Walker, June Jordan, and Maxine Hong Kingston. Students are required to write a reading journal, analytical essays, and a research paper. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods. Most writing is done outside of class.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2224 - Autobiography

Credits: 4

This course deals with autobiography as a form of personal expression. It explores a major compulsion among writers to look back on their growth and examines the need to communicate the historic vision to the next generation. The interaction between the inner and the outer world, between the quest for personal freedom and the demands for social conformity provides for a vigorous examination of the process of individual growth. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2233 - Environmental Literature

Credits: 4

This lecture/discussion course focuses on developing students' abilities to understand, analyze, and write about the literature of natural scientists and other acclaimed authors. Included are works by Lewis Thomas, Henry David

Thoreau, Carl Sagan, Paul Theroux, Isaac Asimov, and Rachel Carson. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2239 - Horror Literature

Credits: 4

This course will explore common characteristics in the literature of horror and the supernatural. Works of Hawthorne, Poe, and Shelley will be in focus, as will some modern Gothic writers. Film and its comparison to the literature will be explored. Interpretive essays and a research paper are required.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Every year.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2248 - The Lyric: The Poetry of Emotion

Credits: 4

Known as the poetry of emotion, the lyric has been an important vehicle of expression for poets from ancient to present day cultures. The course explores lyrics from a cross-cultural perspective, focusing on the methods poets have employed in order to convey the private, emotional lives of their speakers to the "public," their audience of readers. In addition to studying the lyric, students will read and evaluate critical articles as well as compose reading journals and documented essays in response to the texts. The course stresses training in quotation, citation, and research methods.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.**Note:**

A grade of "C" or above is required to pass these courses.

EL 2310 - Introduction to Literature

Credits: 4

This course is aimed at developing students' personal responses to literature. The focus will be on specific literary genres such as poetry, drama, novel, short story, and non fiction prose. The readings will cover a variety of periods and cultures.

Prerequisites

EC II placement

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 2350 - Reading and Writing for a Multicultural Community

Credits: 4

This course is a historical and contemporary examination of how immigration, race and ethnicity have helped shape both American national identity and personal identity. Students will explore the political, social, educational, and economic aspects of immigration with emphasis on how minority populations adapted to American culture, changing American culture in the process. This study explores the writing of activists, political leaders, authors, and other social reformers to discover how they used the written word as a vehicle for change. Students will read articles, speeches, memoirs, poems and short fiction and discuss the various societal issues that they would like to address through writing. Their work will reach audiences beyond their class and serve tangible purposes for community groups and the students themselves.

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 3010 - Structure and Grammar of English

Credits: 4

This course places formal English grammar in the context of the structure and development of the language. Devoting significant attention to the evolution of English and its overall structure, the course also offers intensive study of standard grammar, aimed at both Literature and Teaching students. Students study parts of speech, parts of the sentence, verb and pronoun forms and agreement, and the uses of phrases and clauses within sentences, and they learn to identify these in their writing and the writings of others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 3200 - Peer Mentoring Tutorial

Credits: 4

Students enrolled in Peer Mentoring Tutorial will work under the supervision of a faculty mentor and will, in turn, serve as mentor to selected students. Following an orientation seminar, student mentors will regularly attend an assigned class, assist students in and outside the class with papers, homework, course material, as well as serving as peer advisor. Student mentors will keep records of meetings with mentees, submitting written reports at regular intervals on each mentee. Mandatory attendance at scheduled Peer Mentoring Tutorial. Term report required.

Prerequisites

“B+” average, recommendation of faculty

When Offered:

Every semester. Enrollment is limited to English majors and School of Education English concentrators, and requires permission of one faculty mentor.

EL 3500 - Literature Across Cultures I: Analysis

Credits: 4

This course explores representative works of U.S. and international literature that find their roots in the world's multiplicity of cultures. The course emphasizes multiple strands and traditions both within world literary culture and within the literary cultures of the United States and other nations. Readings and discussions focus on the dominant themes in fiction, poetry, drama, and essays by writers of distinct national and ethnic identities, genders, and sexual orientations. The course also includes studies of writings about multicultural contributions to literature.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 3510 - Literature Across Cultures II: Theory

Credits: 4

This course encourages diverse responses to important works of British-U.S. and World Literature. It fosters the skills of close reading and develops the confidence necessary for independent interpretation of literary texts. While studying each text, students read critical articles about them reflecting the approaches of "new criticism," biographical and psychoanalytic criticism, new historicism, feminism, queer theory, and other current methodologies. Small group discussions of study questions, oral reports, and writing assignments encourage students to read the texts specifically and respond to them independently.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 3560 - Literatures of Europe, Part I: Old Testament and Homer to the Renaissance

Credits: 4

Covers the literary traditions of Europe from the Jewish-Christian Bible to the Renaissance. Works in these traditions have been foundational for most later writing in English, and for much modern World Literature. Selections vary by semester and have recently included works by Homer, Sophocles, Virgil, Dante, Milton, Shakespeare, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Annually.

EL 3561 - Literatures of Europe, Part II: Age of Enlightenment to the Present

Credits: 4

Surveys the literary traditions of Europe and its diaspora from the 17th to the 21st centuries. Works in these traditions have inspired modern U.S. and British as well as World Literature. Selections vary by semester; recently the course has included works by Moliere, Voltaire, Dostoevsky, Ibsen, Kafka, Pirandello, Becket, Borges, Camus, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Annually.

EL 3600 - U.S. Literature I-Colonial Period to Civil War

Credits: 4

Poetry, fiction, essay, and memoir from the colonial period to the U.S. Civil War. Examines significant works representative of Puritanism, the Enlightenment, Romanticism, the "American Renaissance," Transcendentalism, the voices of Native Americans and women, and the literature of Abolitionism as examples of a developing literary nationalism and as expressions of a multicultural society's development and struggles. Authors may include William Bradford, Anne Bradstreet, Benjamin Franklin, Phillis Wheatley, James Fenimore Cooper, Richard Allen, Edgar Allen Poe, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Herman Melville, Ralph Waldo Emerson, Frances E. W. Harper, Frederick Douglass, John G. Whittier, Walt Whitman, William Wells Brown, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every Fall.

EL 3610 - U.S. Literature II-Civil War to the Present

Credits: 4

Poetry, fiction, drama, essay, and memoir from the U.S. Civil War to the present. Examines significant works representing realism, naturalism, modernism, and postmodernism in literary technique and responding to the evolution and tensions of a multicultural society, including the labor, immigration, civil rights, feminist, and lesbian-gay experiences. Authors may include Mark Twain, Emily Dickinson, Henry James, Charles Chesnutt, W.E.B. Du Bois, Sui Sin Far, Willa Cather, Edith Wharton, Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, Ernest Hemingway, William Faulkner, Richard Wright, Tennessee Williams, Ralph Ellison, Gary Soto, August Wilson, Oscar Hijuelos, Louise Erdrich, Toni Morrison, Audre Lorde, Thom Gunn, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every Spring.

EL 3700 - Survey of World Literature

Credits: 4

A study of representative works of world literature from Antiquity to the Modern. The course emphasizes the study and consideration of the literary, cultural, and human significance of selected masterpieces of the Western and non-Western literary traditions. An important objective of the course is to promote an understanding of the literary works in their cultural/historical contexts and of the enduring human values which unite the different literary tradi tions of the world. This course complements EL 3560 - Literatures of Europe, Part I: Old Testament and Homer to the Renaissance - EL 3561 - Literatures of Europe, Part II: Age of Enlightenment to the Present , and so focuses largely on literatures of the non-Western world.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every year.

EL 3800 - English Literature I: Beowulf to 18th Century, inclusive of Shakespeare

Credits: 4

A survey course examining the works of major English writers from the Anglo-Saxon period through the 18th century, including the Beowulf poet, Chaucer, Shakespeare, Milton, and Swift. Attention paid to their influence on later writers.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every Fall.

EL 3810 - English Literature II: Romantics to Present

Credits: 4

A survey course studying major English writers of the 19th and 20th centuries from the romantic and Victorian periods to contemporary times. Authors may include Wordsworth, Keats, Brontë, G. Eliot, R. Browning, Hardy, Woolf, Joyce, Shaw, and Yeats. Attention paid to their influence on later writers.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every Spring.

EL 3865 - Literature of Asia

Credits: 4

This course focuses on the reading and discussion of a number of literary masterpieces, both traditional and contemporary, drawn from the cultures of China, Japan, and India. The range of works presented will provide foundation for considering the influence of history and religion on literature, as well as the ways in which literature

shapes culture.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 3870 - Literatures of Africa

Credits: 4

Presents a series of masterworks from African literature and its diaspora against the background of traditional culture, social values, and historical experience. The techniques used by African wordsmiths to evoke their society are examined, beginning with traditional epic oral literature and finishing with the sophisticated works of some of the world's finest writers. Works by Soyinka, Fugard, Césaire, Achebe, Senghor and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Annually.

EL 3880 - Masterpieces of Hispanic Literature

Credits: 4

Selections of outstanding literary works of Spain and Latin America from the picaresque novel to the present. Study includes major writers: Cervantes, Lorca, Unamuno, García Márquez, and others. Given in English.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 3901 - Introduction to Creative Writing

Credits: 4

Workshop to help imaginative students get their thoughts on paper. Assignments are short and personal, designed to break through “writing block” and uncover talent that might otherwise be neglected. Attention is given to literary forms and terminology.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 3920 - The Art of Writing Poetry

Credits: 4

This course is designed for writers of poetry to hone their craft and elevate their writing skills. Assignments are short and personal, designed to cultivate students’ personal writing styles and voices. Students will closely study a variety of published poets of different cultures, time periods, and styles. The course will serve as an introduction to the writing of original poetry in various forms including sonnet, haiku, free verse and more. In addition to working within literary conventions to produce a portfolio of poetry, students will learn to critique their own work and the work of their peers by participating in weekly writing workshops.

Prerequisites

WRITING O.W. 50 or Undergraduate level EL 2203

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2206

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2208

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2211

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2214

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2216

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2218

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2219

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2221

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2222

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2224

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2233

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2239

Minimum Grade of C or Undergraduate level EL 2248

Minimum Grade of C

When Offered:

Offered every semester.**Note:**

Course Attributes: The Arts -23, Creativity and the Arts, Liberal Arts

EL 3930 - Language and Communications Skills for Educators: Issues and Applications

Credits: 4

This course deals with contemporary issues of importance to those contemplating a profession in the field of education. It places special emphasis on improvement of reading, writing, and listening skills, making use of timely professional journal articles as a text. Topics include Writing Across the Curriculum, Standards and Assessment, Classroom Management and Initiation into Professional Life. Reading and discussion of the articles, analysis of grammatical structure, the development of writing skills for the classroom and for achieving success on State exams, and improvement of public speaking to be a successful public educator will be stressed. This course may be required as a condition of satisfying the writing entrance requirement in the School of Education.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 3950 - Creative Non-Fiction

Credits: 4

Introduces students to the tradition of creative non-fiction, using readings and writing assignments in which students "adopt" an authorial voice. Students will compare and contrast standard news accounts of an event with creative non-fiction versions in order to see how literary techniques re-define history. Students will analyze and apply different aesthetic strategies for writing creative non-fiction. Some of the authors we will cover are James Baldwin, Alice Walker,

Ocatvio Paz, Charles Baudelaire, Grandmaster Flash and the Furious Five, Ai.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4000 - Native American Literature

Credits: 4

This course explores Native American literary styles such as autobiography and as-told-to narrative from oral traditions as well as contemporary genres: poetry, short fiction, the novel and drama. Special emphasis on structural and thematic elements provides students with an understanding of the Native American world view.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4010 - The Harlem Renaissance

Credits: 4

The Harlem Renaissance of the 1920's decade produced an unprecedented outpouring of artistic works in the literary, visual, and musical arts. From lectures, close textual analysis of assigned readings, student-centered discus sions, and oral reports, the class will become familiar with major themes and key writings of Harlem Renaissance authors. Attention will be paid to the struggles of the "New Negro Woman" in her attempt to find a voice during the period.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4015 - Multi-Ethnic Literatures of the United States

Credits: 4

Asian American, Latino, and Native American Literatures play an increasingly important part in the multi-ethnic literary traditions of the United States. This course offers an introduction to one or more of these literatures. Readings include both classic and present-day works in varied genres. The course will include attention to historical contexts, cultural and political meanings, and aesthetic qualities of the literatures. Coverage may vary in different offerings of the course.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4020 - Asian American Literature

Credits: 4

This course examines memoirs, stories, novels, essays, poems, dramas, and films from the 1890s to the 1990s, by Americans of diverse Asian descent, such as Sui Sin Far, Younghill Kang, Carlos Bulosan, Maxine Hong Kingston, John Okada, Hisaye Yamamoto, Amy Tan, Chang-Rae Lee, and Bharati Mukherjee. Attention will be paid to the historic, biographical, and cultural contexts of each text as well as the aesthetic and literary aspects of its style, language, and structure.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4030 - Women and Narrative

Credits: 4

This course examines novels, stories, letters, journals, poems, essays, and autobiographies by such women as Dorothy Wordsworth, Emily Dickinson, Charlotte Forten, Virginia Woolf, Nella Larsen, Alice Walker, Gloria Anzaldua, and Maxine Hong Kingston. Each student will select the work of one writer for a research paper.

Prerequisites

EMS

EL 4040 - Black Women Writers

Credits: 4

African-American Women Writers introduces students to the themes of social justice that are specific to this literary tradition. The course alternates between reading primary texts and providing the needed historical backdrop. Of the many ideas to be covered a few will be; love, the claiming of one's body, the dual oppression of being a woman and black and the tug-of-war of loyalty. The course may discuss nineteenth and twentieth century writers in comparative perspective, or may focus on recent major authors such as Toni Morrison, Alice Walker and Lorraine Hansberry as well as lesser known writers like Gayle Jones and Toni Cade Bambara.

Prerequisites

EMS

EL 4050 - Lesbian and Gay Literature

Credits: 4

This course primarily focuses on the emergence of gay, lesbian, and transgender literature and culture from the mid-twentieth century to today. Students will read works from various genres, including novels, stories, drama, poetry, and memoirs, and will also watch documentaries. Topics covered include homophobia, coming out, the gay rights movement, lesbian feminism, AIDS, and transgender. Authors may include James Baldwin, Audre Lorde, Adrienne Rich, Essex Hemphill, Tony Kushner, Jeanette Winterson, Leslie Feinberg, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

EL 4060 - Literature of Class and Class Consciousness

Credits: 4

Class represents a largely unacknowledged "culture" coexisting and interacting with others such as ethnic cultures, women's experience, and lesbian/gay culture. This course looks at fiction, poetry, and drama about class and class conflict, primarily by writers from working-class backgrounds. Examining class and class consciousness, and the interaction of class and race in the U.S., we will explore how literature has been a medium for members of oppressed groups to voice their experiences, world views, and demands, and also for members of more privileged groups to respond to social change.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4070 - Topics in African American Literature

Credits: 4

This course will give an in-depth look at a particular period or genre of African American literature. Topics are offered on a rotating basis. They may include African American Literature 1860- 1920; African American Women Writers since the Harlem Renaissance; the "Social Realist" School (for example, Wright, Petry, Killens, Himes); the Black Arts Movement; and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4080 - Extraordinary Bodies: Disability in Literature

Credits: 4

This course will examine how the depiction of bodily difference in literature leads to crucial questions about normative experience, language, and identity. The course will study the representation of extraordinary bodies in several literary genres autobiography, poetry, fiction, and drama. While some attention will be given to constructions of disability throughout literary history, the particular focus will be on more recent texts written by writers with disabilities who take up the project of identifying themselves outside of "ablist" terms.

Prerequisites

EMS

EL 4090 - The Afro-American Novel

Credits: 4

The exploration of the socio-cultural forces shaping the African-American novel from its earliest antecedents through Wright and Baldwin to its contemporary efflorescence in the works of Toni Morrison, Charles Johnson, Edward P. Jones, and others. Some cross-cultural comparison with African and Caribbean novelists will be made. Titles may vary from semester to semester.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4091 - Afro-American Poetry and Plays

Credits: 4

Beginning with the work of Phillis Wheatley in the 18th century, this course explores the dominant motifs in African-American poetry, with special focus on the work of Langston Hughes and Gwendolyn Brooks. The second half of the course is devoted to a survey of African-American drama during the Harlem Renaissance, and culminates in an in-depth analysis of the work of Amiri Baraka, Charles Fuller and August Wilson.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4100 - English Internship

Credits: 4

Designed to provide majors with grounding in their careers, English Internships are available in a number of specializations, where students work with successful mentors at work sites: Legal Internships in courts and law firms, Publishing Internships in publishing houses, and Cultural Internships in cultural institutions. Enrollment is limited to English majors and requires permission of the chair.

Prerequisites

EMS, "B+" average, and approval of the Chair

EL 4120 - Internship in Peer Tutoring in Language Arts

Credits: 4

The internship in peer tutoring deals with the methodology and content of peer tutoring in language arts. Units include communication skills for language arts tutoring, the tutoring cycle, record-keeping, referrals, evaluating writing, the use of computers in tutoring, small group tutoring, long-range and short range goals, resources for language arts tutoring. Enrollment is limited to English majors and School of Education English concentrators and requires permission of the chair.

Prerequisites

EMS, "A-" average, and approval of the Chair

EL 4200 - Biblical/Classical Influences on Multicultural Literature

Credits: 4

The Jewish-Christian Bible, Greek epic and drama, and classics such as Dante's Divine Comedy profoundly influenced later literature and culture, including U.S. and British multicultural literature. This course covers some of the

background that multicultural writers such as James Baldwin, Toni Morrison, William Faulkner, and others took for granted in their works. We will examine how these classics shaped later culture through both glorification and criticism of war, conquest, and slavery, through ideas of fate and individual and community salvation, and through examining the problem of evil. Readings include classic works and modern works influenced by them.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Annually.

EL 4300 - Twentieth-Century Literature: Colonialism and Post Colonialism

Credits: 4

This course explores selected works of US and British literature in the context of the twentieth-century history of imperialism, colonialism, and post colonialism. We shall read writing from the first half of the century by such authors as W.B. Yeats, Gertrude Stein, Wilfred Owen, Ernest Hemingway, and Sylvia Townsend Warner and its development and critique in works by Zora Neale Hurston, Samuel Beckett, Tim O'Brien, Toni Morrison, Jhumpa Lahiri, and Zadie Smith.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4311 - Greek Drama

Credits: 4

The art of drama is one of the legacies of Greece to Western culture. In this course, the development of Greek tragedy and comedy is discussed; plays by Aeschylus, Sophocles, Euripides, and Aristophanes are read as well as 20th century dramas based on these 5th century works. Some attention is also given to the criticism of Greek tragedy by Plato and Aristotle.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4312 - Greek Mythology

Credits: 4

This course aims to introduce students of widely differing backgrounds and academic preparation to Greek mythology. In addition to Homer's Odyssey which is read in its entirety, students read Hesiod's Theogony and other original source materials. The acquisition of knowledge of the myths paves the way for discussion of the following topics, among others: psychoanalytic and other interpretations of Greek myth, recurrent themes in myth, the relationship between myth and folktale, the transformation of myth by writers and artists, and the role of myth in a scientific and technological society.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 4325 - Shakespeare: Selected Plays

Credits: 4

Selected plays by Shakespeare will be read and examined critically and analytically through discussion of these works and of the historical context of the Elizabethan theater and world view. The focus will also be on the richness and variety of Shakespearean language and thought. Study includes close reading of some well-known Shakespearean tragedies and comedies as well as viewing of plays on film.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4400 - Critical Theory

Credits: 4

Critical theory is perhaps the fastest-growing field of English study since 1980; students entering graduate programs in English now need to have knowledge of the subject. This course will include such classical theorists as Plato and Aristotle but will focus mainly on twentieth-century theory, from the “new” criticism of the 1950s through structuralism, deconstruction ism, new historicism, and feminist historicism to current post-colonialist and queer theory.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4405 - Caribbean Literature

Credits: 4

Literature of the Anglophone Caribbean, from oral song and James’ Minty Alley to Naipaul, Walcott, and writers of the Caribbean diaspora. The complexities of the relationship between colonizer and colonized, the transformation of that relationship by “the unmasking of imperial fictions,” and the evolution of new forms of discourse will govern the selection of texts.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4500 - Topics in British/U.S. Literature

Credits: 4

This course gives in-depth knowledge of particular periods and genres of literature; topics are offered on a rotating basis. They may include nineteenth-century British fiction; periods and genres in U.S literature; seventeenth- and eighteenth-century British literature; women writers 1760- 1840, and others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4510 - Modern Drama and Theater

Credits: 4

This course will involve reading and viewing critically and analytically plays dealing with important themes and political issues from the late nineteenth century to today. Students will learn to see the theater as a social institution, a form of communication, a means of consciousness-raising, and a site for artistic innovation. Plays may include works by Henrik Ibsen, G.B. Shaw, Eugene O'Neill, Eugene Lonesco, Tennessee Williams, Arthur Miller, Lorraine Hansberry, Edward Albee, Amiri Baraka, August Wilson, David Henry Hwang, Tony Kushner and Anna Deveare Smith. Class will likely take at least one trip into Manhattan to see a live performance.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4520 - Reading and Writing the Short Story

Credits: 4

This course is almost equally divided between interpretive analysis of short stories and a workshop approach to creative writing. In the first part of the semester, we read a variety of short stories, with a view toward extracting principles of characterization, description, and voice that can help students begin to create their own stories, guided by exercises. The second half combines readings of literature showing the historical development of the story and the tale with collaborative exercises in which students assist each other in critiquing and revising a complete short story.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4550 - Modern British Literature 1890 - 1960

Credits: 4

Selected works of several writers in English such as Conrad, Shaw, Yeats, Joyce, Eliot, Lawrence, Woolf, O'Casey, and others, who greatly influenced the literature and the thought of the twentieth century.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4560 - Multicultural British Literature since 1960

Credits: 4

Although the global British Empire came to an end in the twentieth century, the literature of Great Britain became increasingly diverse. Waves of immigrants from former parts of the empire, the anti-immigrant fervor of the 1970s- 1980s and its backlash, the women's rights movement, and the continued and often quite creative re-examination of the literary tradition set the stage for the emergence of a provocative body of works reflecting the multicultural nature of contemporary Britain. This course will examine works of poetry, drama, fiction and non-fiction that illustrate the diversity of British literature over the past sixty years. Course material may include works by Philip Larkin, Jean Rhys, Seamus Heaney, Salman Rushdie, Hanif Kureishi, Zadie Smith, Grace Nichols, Jeanette Winterson, Ian McEwan and Monica Ali.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4600 - Literature of India

Credits: 4

Indian tradition regards literature as a way of knowledge as well as aesthetic experience. Through examples of the major epics, classical poetry and drama, the medieval devotional lyrics, and samples of modern Indian literature, this course aims at providing the students an opportunity to gain awareness of the values and attitudes that have shaped the culture of the Indian subcontinent.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4630 - Latin American Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course is a survey of Latin American literature since the conquest. The class will first read and discuss descriptions of the Americas as seen by the first European conquerors as well as pre-Colombian texts written by native Americans. We will then read representative works of various literary periods from baroque poems to "magical-realist" novels. We will analyze such themes as the collision of cultures, "civilization and barbarity", the African influence on Latin American letters and the making of a Latin American identity.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4640 - French Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This survey course is intended to serve as an introduction to French literature from the French classical age, in the 17th century, to the present time. Students will be guided through the reading and analysis of

narrative fiction, plays and poems by major French writers so as to develop an understanding of the aesthetic and intellectual currents that have shaped French literature. Readings will be organized around thematic modules rather than in chronological order. Topics may include: representations of the self; stories of love and desire; the making of modernity; tradition and experimentation; social reflections; colonialism and post-colonialism, among others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4650 - Literature of Russia and Eastern Europe

Credits: 4

This course is a sampling of the wonders of the Russian literary imagination, or, as Vladimir Nabokov might say, of its peculiar magic. No other literature has so influenced literature and thought in the rest of the world; perhaps no other national literature has produced so many world masterpieces in so short a time, the two centuries since Alexander Pushkin's first publication. Russian literature is unique in its engagements with the social world, as Russia has gone through two centuries of political struggles and revolutions, but it also explores the privacy of the human heart and the giant questions of philosophy and religion. The course devotes roughly equal time to 19th and 20th century literature and, in most offerings, will include some literature from Russian-influenced countries in Eastern Europe.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

EL 4800 - Major Authors

Credits: 4

This course examines the development of one or more authors, tracing key themes, influences, shifts and continuities, and aesthetic development in the context of cultural and political forces. Authors are selected on the basis of having made landmark contributions to the continuing development of literature. Recent offerings have included James

Baldwin, William Blake, Ralph Ellison, William Faulkner, F. Scott Fitzgerald, Toni Morrison, Mary Shelley, Mary Wollstonecraft, and Virginia Woolf, and others may be selected in the future.

Prerequisites

EMS, Completion of EL 3500

and EL 3510

Previous 4000 level English courses strongly advised

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 5000 - Senior Seminar I: Research and Writing

Credits: 4

Autobiographical and biographical works focusing on intellectual development aid students in understanding issues of personal and career identity, the impact of literary study on the formation of self, and related topics. Classwork stresses research and documentation skills and participation in a seminar setting in which each student presents some independent research to the class. In preparation for the senior thesis, students compose their own intellectual autobiographies tracing their growth and development as English majors. Students must complete a senior thesis proposal to pass the course.

Prerequisites

EMS, Senior standing Completion of a minimum of 20 to 24 credits in the English major strongly advised

When Offered:

Every semester.

EL 5010 - Senior Seminar II: Thesis

Credits: 4

Under supervision of seminar director, students complete the senior thesis from sequential, critiqued drafts to finished manuscript. Students work intensively with a Thesis Director. Seminar sessions continue development of research and writing skills stressing the integration of research within the student's own analysis and presentation. Sessions include collaborative readings of work in progress, peer review, oral reports, and presentation of senior thesis.

Prerequisites

EMS, Completion of EL 5000

When Offered:

Every semester.
